

For the true movie-going experience, however, you'd need surround sound, and stacking up your 5.1-channel sound setup in a cluster is not the way to get it. As per the definition, surround sound is the spatial imaging of sound from one dimension onto two or three dimensions. Surround sound is generated in many ways. The simplest is to use several speakers around the listener to play audio coming from different directions. Another method involves processing the audio using sound localisation techniques to simulate a 3D sound field using headphones. More importantly surround sound is not limited to placement of speakers along a flat (two-dimensional) plane. Vertically-located audio sources should also be considered.

A very common question is, how do additional speakers yield a better home theatre experience? The centre or middle channel ensures that dialogues always seem to be coming directly from the screen. So viewers sitting at the side, too, would feel as if it's emanating from the screen. Your additional speakers at the side relay the ambient sound and the secondary audio, such as the background score. The heart-pounding bass is, of course, courtesy the subwoofer. Once you have a sound idea about the audio setup, it's time to take a look at the big picture.